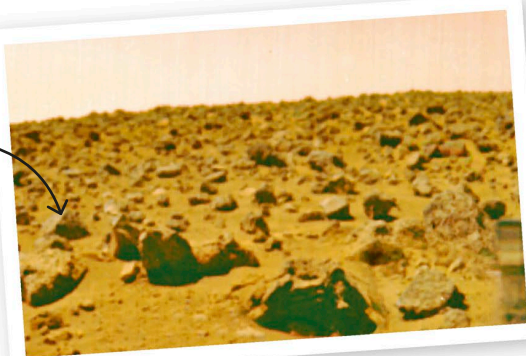


The red dust covers everything on the planet.

The Martian air is always freezing cold.



Viking photo

This photograph of Mars's barren, rocky surface was taken by the American spacecraft *Viking 2*. Scientists are now planning to send an astronaut to Mars. He or she should be on Mars when you are an adult. Perhaps you will become an astronaut, and it could be you!

Storms of dust

Mars has duststorms that can last for weeks. Strong winds pick up the red dust and move it about the surface. With powerful telescopes, we can see the change in the color of Mars as the dust moves around.



Mars has ice caps on its north and south poles.

Swirling red dust

